

Aesthetic Computer

Personal Computers Are Not Done Yet

Jeffrey Alan Scudder · LACMA Art + Technology Lab 2026 · Detailed Project Budget

Artist fee (24 months, Fall 2026 to Fall 2028)	\$22,000
Studio hardware (dev machines, displays)	\$3,500
AC Device Library fleet (12 AC Blank laptops × \$128 flashed with AC OS, incl. cases + shipping + returns)	\$2,000
Mini Rig portable speakers for installation (5 × \$120)	\$600
USB drives, cables, peripherals	\$500
Installation fabrication (furniture, mounts)	\$2,500
Workshop materials (printed guides, KidLisp reference cards)	\$1,200
2027 Symposium “boot the cohort” (cohort demo USB kit, on-site workshop station, travel)	\$2,500
2028 Demo Day “play the room” (multi-station install setup, public-program support, v1.0 release)	\$3,000
Paid event helpers (workshop TAs, install + take-down at Symposium and Demo Day)	\$3,000
Server + compute infrastructure (hosting, CDN, CI/CD)	\$3,500
Documentation production (video, photography, translation)	\$2,000
Contingency (10%)	\$3,700
Total Requested	\$50,000

The 10% contingency line handles budget slip; paid helpers are a direct expense budgeted for the cohort’s two public events. Other funding: open-source sponsorship via GitHub Sponsors and Lib-erapay supplements ongoing infrastructure costs (hosting, domains, CI). Personal / studio funds cover primary ongoing support.

Milestones & disbursement by phase

Fall 2026 to Spring 2027	Library Build-Out & Curriculum. Establish the AC Device Library (12 AC Blanks, lending-fleet infrastructure, waitlist software), design the 3-level KidLisp workshop curriculum, produce printed reference cards.	\$10,000
Spring to Summer 2027	First Library Cohort + Pilots. Open the library waitlist; 2 pilot Flash Days at LACMA; first public borrowing cycle; prototype multi-station installation; v0 open-source build guide.	\$8,000
Fall 2027	2027 Symposium “We boot the cohort.” Cohort artists and library members flash AC Blanks together and take them home. Public KidLisp workshop; talk alongside the 2023 cohort.	\$7,000
Winter 2027 to Summer 2028	Library Scaling + Extended Workshops. Kiosk-mode hardening, library curriculum v1 (EN + ES), 4 additional workshops, returns-and-repair cycle for the fleet, complete documentation of the waitlist and lending system.	\$15,000
Fall 2028	2028 Demo Day “We play the room.” Multi-station AC Native installation premieres on the LACMA floor; Family Play afternoons open the library fleet to visitors of any age; v1.0 of the open-source build pipeline ships, so any institution can run its own room (in the lineage of Nick Montfort’s Trope Tank and other artist-run hardware libraries).	\$10,000
Total Requested		\$50,000